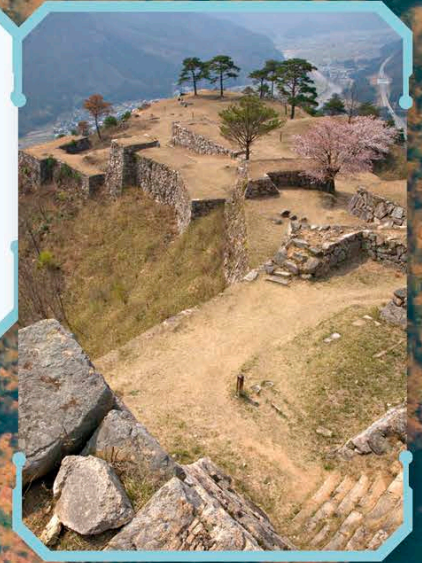


Courtyard complex

Takeda Castle is built around a succession of courtyards, each of which an attacker would have to fight through. The central courtyard in the foreground is where the *daimyo* and his family would have had their living quarters.



The castle's walls were so thickly built that they still stand, more than 400 years since it was abandoned.

Natural defenses

Takeda Castle is positioned on an isolated mountaintop, which gave it a strong defensive position. Abandoned in 1600, its central buildings have crumbled away over time, leaving just the impressive stone walls. Despite being in ruins, the castle's remains still make for an imposing structure today.

The castle's location is so high that it sometimes sits above the clouds.

Civil strife

In the 16th century, Japan suffered a century-long period of civil war, with its *daimyo* fighting each other in attempts to gain land and power. Many built castles to defend themselves. One of the last clashes of the era was the Battle of Sekigahara, shown here.

